17 FILE HANDLING • THEORY

02 file pointers seekg seekp tellg tellp

Detailed Theory, Exact C++ Rules, Memory Models & Exam Reference

02 — File Position Pointers: `seekg`, `seekp`, `tellg`, and `tellp`

- `g` **stands for "get" (input /** `ifstream` **)**, and `p` **stands for "put" (output /** `ofstream` **)**:
  - `tellg()` / `tellp()` : Returns the current byte offset (`streampos`) of the get/put pointer.
  - `seekg(offset, direction)` / `seekp(offset, direction)` : Moves the get/put pointer relative to `ios::beg` (beginning), `ios::cur` (current position), or `ios::end` (end of file).